

When Israel was in Egypt's land

Text: African American spiritual

Music: African American spiritual

GO DOWN MOSES 85.85 with refrain

arr. John W. Work (1871-1925)

The musical score is written for a four-part setting (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in 4/4 time, with a key signature of two sharps (F# and C#). The score is divided into four systems, each with a treble and bass staff. The first system is marked 'Unison' and the second 'Harmony'. Chord symbols are placed above the staves: F#m, Bm, F#m, C#7, and F#m. The lyrics are written below the staves, with three verses of text provided for each system. The first system covers the first two lines of the first verse. The second system covers the next two lines. The third system covers the next two lines. The fourth system covers the final two lines, including the refrain. The score ends with a double bar line.

1 When Is - rael was in E - gypt's land, let my peo-ple go,
2 The Lord told Mo - ses what to do, let my peo-ple go,
3 As Is - rael stood by wa - ter's side, let my peo-ple go,

op - pressed so hard they could not stand, let my peo-ple go.
to lead the He - brew chil-dren through, let my peo-ple go.
at God's com-mand it did di - vide, let my peo-ple go.

Go down, Mo - ses, way down in E - gypt's land,

tell old Pha-raoh: let my peo-ple go.

4. When they had reached the other shore,
let my people go,
they let the song of triumph soar,
let my people go.

5. Lord, help us all from bondage flee,
let my people go,
and let us all in Christ be free,
let my people go.